



League of Legends on ESPN+

The cable sports network said that it has signed a multi-year agreement with LoL's developer Riot Games. <https://digit.in/jun18-A37-1>



Galaxy Note 9 rumored

According to rumors, Galaxy Note 9 variant with 8GB of RAM, 512GB of storage could be coming. <https://digit.in/jun18-A37-2>

Samsung Galaxy S9

Beautiful, compact and iterative

The Samsung Galaxy S9 is a follow-up to last year's Galaxy S8, but looking at the phone, you wouldn't be able to tell them apart. The Galaxy S8's design was not only functional and ergonomic but it also looked stunning too. No need to fix that which isn't broken. While that's definitely a good thing, the Galaxy S9 comes across more like an 'S' variant of the Galaxy S8, much like how Apple uses the term to define minor upgrades to its iPhone lineup.

Camera

What's interesting is that the camera can switch between f/1.5 and f/2.4 depending on the amount of ambient light. But here's the thing. In a time when even mid-range smartphones are shipping with apertures as wide as f/2.0, why would Samsung want to put a tiny f/2.4 aperture? That small an aperture, especially with a tiny 1/2.5-inch sensor will have no use whatsoever in improving the imaging prowess. Ideally, smaller apertures are used to make the photos sharper with tighter exposure and more details. But the sensor size in smartphones will cap the light absorption to a point where the f/2.4 aperture will not make much of a difference.

Selfies come out well detailed with just the right amount of exposure with the option of applying filters and beauty effects. It's pretty standard, the implementation of it. There's a selfie focus mode that can simulate the background blur while a wide selfie can basically take a panorama with the front camera. Both are quite useful and help in augmenting the selfie experience.

Display

The 5.8-inch Infinity display is the



Price
₹57,900



FEATURE.....	76
PERFORMANCE.....	87
VALUE.....	83
DESIGN.....	91

center of attraction of the Galaxy S9. It looks a lot like the one on the Galaxy S8 with the Super AMOLED panel sort of melting into the metal frame along the edges. The QHD+ resolution also remains the same. Being a Super AMOLED display, the black levels are deep with a high contrast ratio.

The default display calibration isn't as oversaturated as on the Galaxy S8.

Performance

The Samsung Galaxy S9 and the S9+ has the same set of hardware under the hood — Samsung's proprietary Exynos 9810 in global markets and the Snapdragon 845 in the US and some other regions.

Benchmark reports peg the Galaxy S9 higher than all other flagships from last year, although it wasn't at par with the S9+. 3DMark Slingshot gave a

score of 3801 as compared to 3884 on the S9+ while on AnTuTu the difference was of 40,000 points. That's an unusually high difference and we are probing it further. Geekbench's single core performance between the two was similar, but the multi-core performance was less by about 900 points (which again is alarmingly high).

Battery

The Samsung Galaxy S9 takes after its predecessor in terms of the battery capacity as well. The phone retains the 3,000mAh battery, but the power-hungry Exynos chipset does not give the same result. As we noted in the performance section, the Exynos chipsets of the Galaxy S9 is hungrier to take power which depletes the battery quicker than its predecessor.

A good battery life should be a given when you are splurging half a lakh rupees on a device that is a phone first and then everything else. All the innovation and all the design improvements aside, a dead phone is an useless piece of junk in the pocket.

Verdict

All things combined, the Samsung Galaxy S9 comes across more of an iteration of last year's innovation than a step forward towards the future. It's futuristic design will surely catch the eyes of onlookers but more often than not, it will be mistaken for the older Galaxy S8. The camera too will not make much an impact in making your social media game stronger, and more often than not, you may find yourself red-faced when the phone unexpectedly runs out of power while you're showing off all the cool features the Galaxy S9 struts.

—Subhrojit Malik

SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: Exynos 9810 | GPU: Mali-G72 | OS: Android 8.0 (Oreo) | CARD SLOT: microSD, up to 400 GB | DISPLAY TYPE: Super AMOLED | SIZE: 5.8 inches | RESOLUTION: 1440 x 2960 pixels | CAMERA PRIMARY: Dual 12 MP, f/1.5 & f/2.4, OIS | CAMERA SECONDARY: 8 MP, f/1.7, 1.22 µm pixel size.

CONTACT

SAMSUNG INDIA | PHONE: 1800-40-7267864 | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: www.samsung.com/in